approval for implementing India's schedule of concessions. The tariff concessions are to be implemented 30 days after a minimum of four participants ratify their schedules of concessions. So far India and Malaysia have ratified their schedules.

AUTONOMOUS BODIES

The Government of India, time to time did set up many autonomous bodies in the form of boards, councils, organisations, etc. to promote the cause of external trade. A brief account of them is given below here:

Coffee Board

The **Coffee Board** was set up under Section (4) of the Coffee Act, 1942. It is the oldest Board under the Department of Commerce. The primary functions of the Board include formulating and implementing programmes and projects for growth and development of the coffee industry; promoting coffee consumption in India and exports in the international market; supporting research, extension and developmental activities for raising productivity; evolving pest and disease-resistant varieties; and prescribing and enforcing quality standards at all stages. The Board is headed by a Chairperson and functions from Bangalore. The Board administers four Regional Coffee Research Stations, a Coffee Research Institute, a number of Regional Field Stations and Coffee Demonstration Farms.

Rubber Board

The **Rubber Board** was set up under Section (4) of the Rubber Act, 1947 with headquarters at Kottayam and five Zonal Offices, thirty-nine Regional Offices, a number of Field Stations, Rubber Development Centres and Regional nurseries. It is headed by a Chairman. The Board is engaged in the development of the rubber industry. This is done by assisting and encouraging scientific, technical and economic research; supplying technical advice to rubber growers; training growers in improved methods